

to search forward for an expression, you can use *C-M-s* followed by the *Enter* key, which will prompt you in the mini buffer with the string ‘Regex search:’. You can then enter a regular expression. This will only match the first occurrence of the text and the search will then terminate. You can perform a one-time backward regular expression search using the *C-M-r* short cut. To perform an incremental forward search, you need to use *C-M-s* and you will be prompted with the string ‘Regex I-search:’, where you can provide the pattern to match. For example, ‘[a-z]+[a-z]+' will match both the expressions ‘org-mode’ and ‘double-edged’ in the poem. You can use *C-M-r* for an incremental backward regex search.

A common use case is to find and replace text in a buffer. The sequence to be used is *M-x query-replace* followed by the *Enter* key. You will then be prompted with the string ‘Query replace:’ where you will be asked which word or phrase is to be replaced. For example, if you mention ‘ode’, it will again prompt you with ‘Query replace ode with:’ and then you can enter the replacement string. You can also search and replace text by matching a regular expression with the *C-M-%* shortcut key combination.

Frames

The outermost user interface boundary of GNU Emacs is called a frame. In fact, when you split the GNU Emacs user interface, you are actually creating windows. So, in GNU Emacs, you have windows inside a frame. This is in contrast to today’s user applications, where the entire application is contained in a ‘window’. This is important terminology to remember when using GNU Emacs.

You can create a new frame using the *C-x 5 2* key combination. You can move the cursor to the next frame using *C-x 5 o* (the letter ‘o’), and delete the current frame using the *C-x 5 0* (zero) shortcut. This will not delete the existing buffers, but only the view. In order to open a file in a new frame, you can use *C-x 5 f*. You can also open a file in a new frame in read-only mode using *C-x 5 r*. To switch to the buffer in a new frame, use the *C-x 5 b* key combination.

Windows

You can split a frame vertically to create two windows using *C-x 2* (Figure 1).

To split horizontally, you can use *C-x 3* (Figure 2).

To move the cursor to the next window, use *C-x o* (the letter ‘o’). You can delete the current window using *C-x 0* (zero). Note that this does not delete the buffer, but just the view. If you have multiple windows, want to retain the current window and remove the rest of the windows from the display, you can use *C-x l*.

You can open a file in a new window using *C-x 4 f*. You can also select an existing buffer in another window using *C-x 4 b*. If you have multiple windows that you would like to

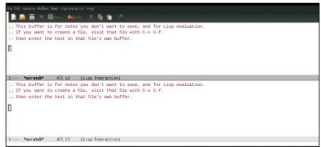


Figure 1: Split frame vertically



Figure 2: Split frame horizontally

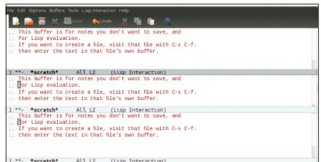


Figure 3: Balanced windows

be balanced equally, you can use *C-x +*. Figure 3 shows an Emacs screenshot with three windows that are balanced.

You can scroll the contents in the other window using *C-M-v*. You can scroll backwards using *C-M-Shift-v*.

You can also use the following shortcuts in your `~/.emacs` to simplify the shortcuts used to split and remove windows:

```
(global-set-key (kbd "C-1") 'delete-other-windows)
(global-set-key (kbd "C-2") 'split-window-below)
(global-set-key (kbd "C-3") 'split-window-right)
(global-set-key (kbd "C-6") 'delete-window)
```

If you would like to make a window wider, you can use the *C-x }* shortcut and, to reduce it horizontally, you will need to use *C-x {*. You can use a prefix count to perform the operation ‘n’ times. For example, use *C-u 5 C-x {* to shrink a window horizontally. To make a window taller, you can use the *C-x ^* short cut; and to make it smaller, you have to use a negative prefix, for example, *C-u -1 C-x ^*. 

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